

- **Looking for easy money? If your company offers a 401(k), contribute at least as much as your employer will match. A fifty-cent match for every dollar you put in is the same as earning a 50% return on your investment.**
- **Figure out whether a traditional or Roth IRA makes more sense for you. Many younger people have more to gain from Roth IRAs. See box A Word About 529 Investment Plans for details and look at IRA comparison calculators like the ones at www.morningstar.com and www.moneychimp.com.**
- **Don't cash in your 401(k) when you lose or change jobs. Roll it over instead.**
- **If you work for yourself, check out SEPs, SIMPLE IRAs, and Solo 401(k)s. These plans may permit you to sock away far more for your retirement than you could with a traditional or Roth IRA.**
- **Take advantage of the Saver's Credit if you're eligible. If your income is relatively low, you can get a rebate of up to \$1,000 a year from the government by contributing to an IRA or 401(k).**